

AI RESEARCH & FACT VERIFICATION



RESEARCH SMART. VERIFY FACTS. BUILD TRUST.

AI RESEARCH & FACT VERIFICATION

You already know that AI can write, summarize, brainstorm, and explain things.



But here's the problem:
What if AI gives you an answer
that sounds completely correct...
but is actually wrong?

THIS IS ESPECIALLY DANGEROUS
IN BUSINESS RESEARCH.



Imagine you're preparing a presentation
for your BBA class and you tell your teacher:

"According to a 2025 report, 72%
of Indian consumers prefer
AI-powered shopping."



Your teacher asks:
**"Where did you
get that number?"**



And you say:
**"ChatGPT
told me."**



**That's not
research.**



AI

Answer

72% of Indian consumers
prefer AI-powered shopping
(2025 report).



**RELIABLE
RESEARCH**

- ☒ Find Source
- ☒ Verify Facts
- ☒ Check Credibility
- ☒ Use Reliable Data



TODAY, WE'RE GOING TO LEARN HOW TO TURN
AN AI ANSWER INTO RELIABLE RESEARCH.

LET'S START WITH A CHALLENGE



Imagine I ask you:

“What is the most popular social media platform among Indian consumers in 2026?”

You ask an AI tool.

It immediately gives you:



Instagram is the most popular platform among Indian consumers, with **78%** of users actively engaging with the platform.



Sounds convincing.



This is where
AI RESEARCH SKILLS
become important.



NOW ASK YOURSELF:



How do you know that **78%** is real?



Where did the **number** come from?



Who conducted the research?



When was the research conducted?



How many people were surveyed?



Was it **India-specific**?



Is the **source** actually saying what the AI claims?

AI IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY A RESEARCH SOURCE



AI CAN HELP YOU:



Find
information



Explain
information



Summarize
information



Compare
information



Discover
sources



Generate
research
questions



**BUT AI ITSELF ISN'T NECESSARILY THE
ORIGINAL SOURCE OF THE INFORMATION.**



REMEMBER:
AI GIVES YOU AN **ANSWER**.
RESEARCH GIVES YOU **EVIDENCE**.

ONE FUNDAMENTAL DIFFERENCE

AI GIVES YOU

AN ANSWER

VS.

RESEARCH GIVES YOU

EVIDENCE

EXAMPLE:



You ask AI:
“What is India’s current GDP growth rate?”



AI gives you a number.



The next question should be:
“According to whom?”

Maybe the information comes from:



Government
data



World
Bank



IMF



RBI



A research
organization



A company
report



A
newspaper



An academic
paper



**YOUR JOB IS TO FIND THE
ORIGINAL OR AUTHORITATIVE SOURCE.**

WHAT IS AI-ASSISTED RESEARCH?



AI-assisted research means:

Using AI to make the research process faster without giving up your responsibility to **verify** the **information**.

TRADITIONAL RESEARCH



Search



Open 20 websites



Read



Take notes



Compare



Write



TIME TAKING

Many steps.
Lots of searching.

AI-ASSISTED RESEARCH



Ask



Discover sources



Read



Compare



Verify



Write



TIME SAVING

AI helps you find, summarize and organize information faster.



AI CAN **REDUCE THE AMOUNT OF TIME** YOU SPEND **SEARCHING**.



BUT THE **VERIFICATION** STEP REMAINS.



AI RESEARCH TOOLS

Today we'll focus on tools such as:



PERPLEXITY

Useful for asking research questions and discovering information with **cited sources**.



GEMINI

Useful for research, summarization, comparison and working with information from **multiple sources**.



GENERAL AI ASSISTANTS

They can also help **explain** information, generate **research questions** and **analyze** material.



Different AI tools may produce **different answers**.



LET'S TEST THIS

Ask three AI tools:

“ What are the *biggest* challenges facing Indian e-commerce businesses? ”

AI TOOL 1



May focus on:

LOGISTICS



AI TOOL 2



May focus on:

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION



AI TOOL 3



May focus on:

COMPETITION



AI TOOL 4



May focus on:

REGULATION



Does that automatically mean one AI is lying?

NO. They may be interpreting the question differently or using different information.



THAT'S WHY **SOURCE VERIFICATION** MATTERS.



SOURCE DISCOVERY

EXAMPLE RESEARCH TOPIC:



“The growth of
quick-commerce in India.”

AI MIGHT MENTION:



Blinkit



Zepto



Swiggy Instamart



Consumer behavior



Delivery times



Market size



That's useful.
But now you need evidence.

Ask AI:

“Give me the **original sources**
supporting these claims.”



AI HELPS YOU DISCOVER ORIGINAL SOURCES



COMPANY REPORTS

Annual reports, earnings reports, business updates



INVESTOR PRESENTATIONS

Investor decks, quarterly presentations



INDUSTRY REPORTS

Reports from consulting firms, industry bodies



GOVERNMENT STATISTICS

Data from official government sources



RESEARCH ORGANIZATIONS

Surveys and studies from reputed organizations



REPUTABLE BUSINESS PUBLICATIONS

Articles from trusted business news platforms

SOURCES



FROM AI-GENERATED INFORMATION



TO **SOURCE-BACKED RESEARCH**

THE SOURCE HIERARCHY

Not every source has the same level of reliability.

Imagine you're researching:



India's inflation.

Which would you trust more?



A

Source A

A random Instagram post.



B

Source B

A business blog.



C

Source C

A newspaper article.



D

Source D

Official government statistics.



GENERAL HIERARCHY OF SOURCE RELIABILITY

1
HIGHEST



Official / Primary Sources

Examples:

Government reports, official statistics, regulatory bodies, census data

Most reliable for facts and statistics.

2
HIGH



Academic / Research Sources

Examples:

Research papers, journals, university studies, working papers

Well-researched and peer-reviewed.

3
MEDIUM



News & Reputable Publications

Examples:

Newspapers, business magazines, reputable news websites

Reliable for context, analysis and updates.

4
LOWEST



Blogs, Social Media, User Content

Examples:

Blogs, forums, Instagram posts, tweets, YouTube comments

Can be biased, unverified or misleading.

Most
Reliable



Least
Reliable



The reliability of a source depends on what you're trying to prove.

Remember:

Always **evaluate the source** before you use the information.



ASK: “WHO IS SAYING THIS?”

One of the easiest **fact-checking habits**.



Suppose AI says:

“Indian consumers are increasingly choosing sustainable products.”



Don't immediately accept it.
Ask the right questions.



FACT-CHECKING MINDSET

Good research is not about what AI says.
It's about what **evidence** proves.



REMEMBER:

Always ask: **Who? When? Where? How many?**

01 WHO SAID THIS?



Was it:

- A government survey?
- A university?
- A company selling sustainable products?

- A random website?
- A research organization?



02



WHEN?

A study from 2018
may not tell you
what's happening
in 2026.



03



WHERE?

A global survey may
not represent Indian
consumers.



Global



India-specific



04



HOW MANY PEOPLE?

A survey of 50 people
isn't equivalent to
a survey of 50,000.



50

people

VS



50,000

people



The more specific and **credible** the source,
the more **reliable** the information.

CITATION TRACING



A VERY IMPORTANT RESEARCH SKILL



Don't stop at the AI answer.
Find the **original evidence**.

HOW CITATION TRACING WORKS



You are moving backward to the truth.

AI Statement → Citation → Source → Original Evidence



THE GOAL:
Verify, don't just trust.



EXAMPLE: TRACING A STATISTIC

AI ANSWER (Example)

"According to a recent study,
65% of consumers prefer
personalized recommendations." [1]

STEP 1: CLICK THE CITATION

Click on [1] to view the source.



STEP 2: OPEN THE ORIGINAL SOURCE

You are taken to the original report / study.
Read the relevant section.



STEP 3: VERIFY THE INFORMATION

Check: Does the source actually say 65%?



IF YES

Great! Your information
is source-backed.



IF NO

The AI may have
misinterpreted or
oversimplified.



Good researchers don't stop at answers.
They follow the trail to **evidence**.

THE CITATION TRAP



A REAL SOURCE ≠ EXACT CLAIM SUPPORT



AI CLAIM:

“According to XYZ Research, **70%** of students use AI for academic research.”



SOURCE CHECK:

The report actually says:
“70% of surveyed students **have experimented** with generative AI.”



These are
NOT the
same claim.



WHY THIS HAPPENS:

- AI may interpret the source too loosely.
- AI may paraphrase instead of matching the exact meaning.
- AI may pick a related but not identical statement.

HOW TO AVOID THE CITATION TRAP:



- 1 Read the original source (not just the AI summary).
- 2 Check whether the source supports the **exact claim**.
- 3 Look for the context around the statistic.
- 4 Be alert to vague or misleading interpretations.



WHAT TO CHECK:

- ✓ Does the source say the **same thing**?
- ✓ Is the statistic used in the **same context**?
- ✓ Is the **time period** and **population** the same?



THE KEY TAKEAWAY:

Never verify only whether the source exists.
Verify whether the source supports the exact claim.



SMART RESEARCHERS DON'T JUST ACCEPT AI ANSWERS — THEY **VERIFY**.

CROSS-VERIFICATION

DON'T RELY ON ONE SOURCE. VERIFY WITH MANY.



One source = Information
Multiple credible sources =
Stronger Evidence

1 FIND A STATISTIC

Example: "India's e-commerce market will reach \$200B by 2026."



2 FIND CREDIBLE SOURCES

Look for different types of reliable sources.



3 COMPARE & ANALYZE

Do the sources say the same thing?
Check numbers, scope & context.



4 INCREASE CONFIDENCE

If multiple credible sources agree, your confidence increases.



EXAMPLE: SIZE OF INDIA'S E-COMMERCE MARKET BY 2026

SOURCE 1: INDUSTRY REPORT



Report: RedSeer Strategy Consultants (2023)

Finding: India's e-commerce market will reach \$200B by 2026.

Range Mentioned: \$190B – \$210B

SOURCE 2: GOVERNMENT DATA



Source: DPIIT – India E-commerce Report (2023)

Finding: E-commerce GMS in India expected to reach \$180–\$200B by 2026.

Range Mentioned: \$180B – \$200B

SOURCE 3: RESEARCH ORGANIZATION



Report: Statista – E-commerce in India (2023 Update)

Finding: India's e-commerce market projected to reach \$190B by 2026.

Range Mentioned: \$180B – \$200B



CONCLUSION

All three credible sources independently point to a similar range:



STRONG EVIDENCE:

India's e-commerce market is expected to be around
\$180B – \$210B by 2026.



CHECK BEFORE YOU USE A STATISTIC

- ✓ Is the source credible and authoritative?
- ✓ Is the data recent?
- ✓ Is the scope (India / global / specific segment) clear?
- ✓ Does the sample size / methodology make sense?



TIPS

- Look for the most recent and relevant data.
- Prefer official data, industry reports, and reputed research.
- Cross-verify key numbers before including them in your work.

Good research is not about finding data, it's about verifying it.

LET'S DO A QUICK **CLASSROOM EXAMPLE**

Research is not just asking AI. It's investigating and verifying.



AI SAYS...



"The Indian EV market will grow by **40% annually** over the next five years."



SHOULD YOU USE THIS DIRECTLY IN YOUR ASSIGNMENT?

No. Let's investigate.



KEY TAKEAWAY

Strong research is built on questioning, verification, and clarity—**not** just copying answers.



INVESTIGATE BEFORE YOU USE



Question 1
Who predicted 40%?

Is it a company, research firm, government body, analyst, or news article?



Question 2
When was the prediction made?

A prediction from 2021 may not reflect current trends in 2026.



Question 3
What exactly does "EV market" mean?

Does it mean:

- Electric cars
- Two-wheelers
- Three-wheelers
- Total EV sales
- Revenue



Question 4
Is 40% historical growth or future prediction?

Is it past data (what happened) or a forecast (what is expected)?



Question 5
What is the original source?

Find and read the original report, study, or publication.

THE RIGHT RESEARCH PROCESS



1. ASK

Ask the right research question.



2. INVESTIGATE

Dig deeper and find credible sources.



3. VERIFY

Check accuracy, context, and reliability.



4. UNDERSTAND

Understand the data, meaning, and limitations.



5. CITE

Use it responsibly and give proper credits.



REMEMBER: Good research builds credibility. Verified information builds trust.



QUESTION EVERYTHING. VERIFY ALWAYS.



RESEARCH ACTIVITY

Practice AI-assisted research, source verification and fact-checking.



- ✓ Ask smart questions
- ✓ Verify with reliable sources
- ✓ Think critically



1 STEP 1 — ASK AI

Start with this prompt:

"I am researching [TOPIC].
Give me an overview of the topic and identify:
1. Major trends
2. Important statistics
3. Major companies or organizations involved
4. Key factors driving the trend
5. Potential challenges
For every important factual claim, provide a source.
Do not invent statistics or sources."

2



STEP 2 — PICK 3 IMPORTANT CLAIMS

Suppose AI gives you 15 facts. Don't try to verify everything. Select three important claims.

- ✓ **Claim 1:** The market grew by X%.
- ✓ **Claim 2:** Consumer adoption increased by X%.
- ✓ **Claim 3:** Company X has X million users.

3



STEP 3 — TRACE THE SOURCES

For each claim, ask: Where did this information come from? Then locate the original source and verify it.

Claim	Source	Date	Verified?
Market growth	Source A	2026	Yes ✓
Consumer adoption	Source B	2025	Yes ✓
Company users	Source C	2026	No ✗

The last one needs more investigation.

4



STEP 4 — CROSS-VERIFY

Take your most important claim.
Search for another credible source.
Ask: Does another reliable source support this claim?

- ✓ Yes → Confidence increases
- ⚠ Partially → Investigate further
- ✗ No → Recheck the claim

5



STEP 5 — CREATE YOUR SUMMARY

Create a short, source-backed summary.



EXAMPLE COMPLETED WORKSHEET

TOPIC CHOSEN: **Growth of Quick Commerce in India**



OVERVIEW (From AI Research)

- Quick commerce (10–30 min delivery) is rapidly expanding in India's urban markets.
- Driven by rising internet penetration, changing lifestyles and demand for convenience.
- Major players include Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart, BigBasket Now, Dunzo Daily.
- Investors are funding this space heavily.



KEY TRENDS IDENTIFIED

- Rapid expansion in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities
- Dark store network scaling quickly
- Rising order frequency and basket size
- Strong funding and investor interest
- Intense competition and price wars



THREE IMPORTANT CLAIMS (Selected)

Claim 1

The quick commerce market in India is projected to grow at a CAGR of ~35% from 2023 to 2030.

Claim 2

Quick commerce orders in India grew by ~140% YoY in 2024.

Claim 3

Blinkit reported over 10 million monthly transacting users as of Dec 2024.

SOURCE TRACING & VERIFICATION

Claim	Source (Original)	Date of Source	Verified?	Notes
Market growth (35% CAGR)	Redseer Strategy Consultants – Quick Commerce Report	Jan 2024	✓ Yes	Figure matches the report
Orders grew 140% YoY	Inc42 – Quick Commerce Market Report 2024	Aug 2024	✓ Yes	YoY growth mentioned in the report
Blinkit 10M MTUs	Blinkit – Annual Report / Investor Update	Dec 2024	✗ No	Blinkit did not disclose exact MTU. Needs more verification.

CROSS-VERIFICATION (For Claim 1 – Market Growth)

Source A (Redseer Report 2024):
CAGR ~35% (2023–2030)



Source B (Inc42 – India Retail Sector Outlook 2024):
CAGR ~30–35% (2023–2028)



Conclusion:
Both credible sources support a high growth trajectory.

FINAL SUMMARY



Title: Growth of Quick Commerce in India

Key Finding: The quick commerce market in India is growing rapidly, with a projected CAGR of ~35% through 2030, driven by urban demand, faster delivery and rising digital adoption.



Evidence: 35% CAGR (Redseer), 140% YoY growth (Inc42), 10M users (Blinkit).



Business Impact: Faster service, higher consumer demand, and new opportunities for retailers and logistics companies.



REMEMBER: Research is not just about asking AI — it's about investigating, verifying, understanding and citing the right sources.



THE “TRUST BUT VERIFY” RULE

Before using an AI-generated fact, ask these 5 questions.



Good research is not about finding answers quickly. It's about finding the **right** answers and proving they are **true**.

1 WHO?



Who is making the claim?

Is it a government agency, research organization, company, expert, or just a random website?

2 WHEN?



How recent is it?

Outdated information may not be relevant today. Check the date of the data or publication.

3 WHERE?



Where did the information come from?

Identify the original source. Is it a reliable and credible publication or platform?

4 WHY?



Why should I trust this source?

Does the source have expertise, authority, objectivity, and a good track record?

5 EVIDENCE?



What evidence supports the claim?

Are there statistics, data, reports, or studies? Can I trace and verify the evidence myself?

EXAMPLE

“According to XYZ Research, 70% of Indian consumers prefer sustainable products.”



WHO?

XYZ Research
(a market research firm)



WHEN?

March 2024
(Recent)



WHERE?

XYZ Research Report 2024
(Original report)



WHY?

Well-known research firm,
methodology disclosed,
no clear bias



EVIDENCE?

Based on a survey of
5,000 Indian consumers;
data tables available



VERDICT: The claim can be used with confidence.



**IF YOU CAN'T ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS,
DON'T CONFIDENTLY USE THE INFORMATION.**



Be curious.
Ask more questions.



Be skeptical.
Verify everything.



Be responsible.
Cite your sources.



Be confident.
Share what's verified.

WHY CAN AI MISREPRESENT SOURCES?

AI is designed to generate useful responses, not to prove truth.

A convincing sentence is not the same as verified evidence.



AI can be helpful.
But verification is essential.
Always check before you trust.

1



MISINTERPRET A SOURCE

AI may misunderstand the context or meaning of the original source.

2



COMBINE INFORMATION FROM DIFFERENT SOURCES

AI may mix facts from multiple sources in a way that changes the meaning.

3



USE OUTDATED INFORMATION

AI may rely on older data that no longer reflects the current situation.

4



MISREAD STATISTICS

AI may misread numbers, percentages, or sample sizes from a source.

5



GIVE AN INCORRECT CITATION

The citation may be wrong, incomplete, or link to something unrelated.

6



ATTRIBUTE INFORMATION TO THE WRONG ORGANIZATION

The data or claim may be wrongly attributed to a specific organization.

7



PRESENT A PREDICTION AS A FACT

Predictions, forecasts, or opinions may be stated as if they are confirmed facts.

8



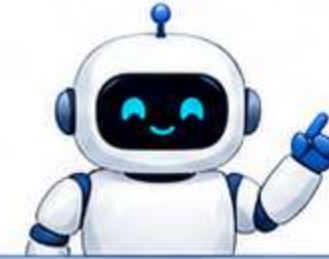
CONFUSE CORRELATION WITH CAUSATION

AI may suggest a cause-effect relationship when only a correlation exists.

EXAMPLE: HOW AI CAN GO WRONG

“According to XYZ Research, 70% of students use AI for academic research.”

AI RESPONSE



AI interprets and presents the claim confidently.

REAL SOURCE SAYS



The actual source says:
“70% of students have experimented with generative AI.”
(Not the same claim.)

WHY VERIFICATION MATTERS



Protects you from misleading or inaccurate information



Helps you make better decisions



Builds credibility in your work and communications



REMEMBER:



CONFIDENCE IS NOT EVIDENCE.

Always verify. Always question. Always think critically.



VERIFY BEFORE YOU RELY.



ONE VERY IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

Understand the difference. Use the right one.



Facts tell us what has happened.
Predictions tell us what might happen.
Never present a prediction as a fact.



FACT (Something that has happened)



EXAMPLE

“Company X reported revenue of ₹X billion in its annual report.”



Key Points

- ✓ Based on actual data and events.
- ✓ Can be verified using credible sources.
- ✓ Example sources: Annual reports, audit reports, government data, official filings.
- ✓ Use with confidence after verification.

Example Source



Company X
Annual Report
FY 2023–24



Key Takeaway: Facts describe the past or present. They can be proven.



PREDICTION (Something that may happen)



EXAMPLE

“Company X's revenue could reach ₹Y billion by 2030.”



Key Points

- ✓ Based on assumptions, models, or expert expectations.
- ✓ It is not a guarantee.
- ✓ Can change over time.
- ✓ Example sources: Industry reports, market research, analyst forecasts.

Example Source



Industry Report
Market Forecast
2024–2030



Key Takeaway: Predictions describe the future. They are uncertain.



Never present a **PREDICTION** as a **FACT**.

Look for these words that indicate a prediction, not a fact:



Expected



Forecast



Estimated



Projected



Could



May



Predicted



REMEMBER:

VERIFY THE FACTS.

UNDERSTAND THE CONTEXT.

USE THE INFORMATION RESPONSIBLY.

COMMON RESEARCH MISTAKES

Avoid these. Research smart, verify always.



Good research isn't about finishing fast.
It's about **getting it right**.

1 COPYING THE FIRST AI ANSWER.



- ✗ The first answer may be incomplete or even incorrect.
- ✗ Always ask follow-up questions and compare answers.

2 TRUSTING A CITATION WITHOUT OPENING IT.



- ✗ A citation may exist but not support the exact claim.
- ✗ Always open and read the source.

3 USING OUTDATED STATISTICS.



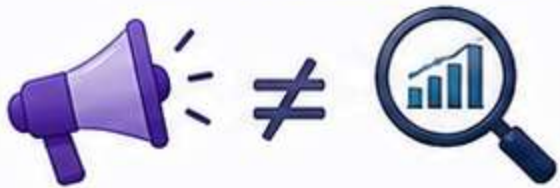
- ✗ Old data may not reflect the current situation.
- ✗ Always check the date and recency of the information.

4 USING ONE SOURCE FOR EVERYTHING.



- ✗ Relying on one source increases the risk of bias or error.
- ✗ Use multiple credible sources to strengthen your findings.

5 CONFUSING A COMPANY'S CLAIM WITH AN INDEPENDENT FINDING.



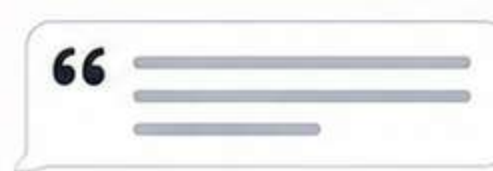
- ✗ Company claims are self-reported and may be biased.
- ✗ Prefer independent research and third-party findings.

6 USING STATISTICS WITHOUT UNDERSTANDING WHAT THEY MEASURE.



- ✗ Numbers can be misleading if you don't know the definition, scope, or method.
- ✗ Understand what the statistic includes, excludes, and how it was calculated.

7 WRITING "ACCORDING TO RESEARCH" WITHOUT IDENTIFYING THE RESEARCH.



- ✗ Vague statements reduce credibility.
- ✗ Always name the source, report, or study you are referring to.

8 TREATING AI CONFIDENCE AS PROOF.



- ✗ AI can sound confident even when it's wrong.
- ✗ Confidence is not evidence—verify every claim.



RESEARCH SMART –
FOLLOW THIS MINDSET



Question
every claim.



Verify every
source.



Cross-check
information.



Understand
before you use.



Credible research
builds credibility.



FINAL CHALLENGE & KEY TAKEAWAYS

AI gives you information. Your job is to **verify** it.

“ Good researchers don’t ask “what did AI say?” They ask “how do we know it’s true?” ”



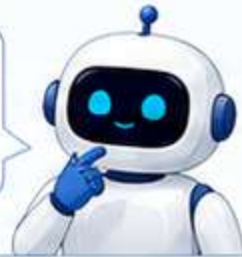
FINAL CHALLENGE

You are preparing a presentation:

“How AI Is Changing Jobs for BBA Students.”

AI gives you this statement:

“ AI will eliminate 40% of all jobs within the next decade. ”



Before you put this on your slide, ask:

- 1 Who made this prediction?
- 2 What does “40%” actually mean?
- 3 Does it mean jobs disappear or jobs change?
- 4 When was the prediction made?
- 5 What is the original source?
- 6 Can another credible source verify it?



That’s the mindset of a researcher.



DON’T ACCEPT—INVESTIGATE



WHO?

Who is making the claim?
Is it an expert, company, or organization?



WHAT?

What does the number/statistic actually mean and include?



HOW?

Does it mean jobs disappear, or jobs change/evolve?



WHEN?

When was the prediction or report published?



SOURCE?

What is the original source?
(Open and read it.)



VERIFY?

Can another credible source confirm the same claim?



Verify → Cross-check → Then use with confidence.



EXAMPLE: THE “40% JOBS” CLAIM

What experts actually say:

- The World Economic Forum (Future of Jobs Report 2023) states that AI and automation may displace 83 million jobs but create 69 million new jobs by 2027.
- McKinsey (2023) says up to 30% of current work activities could be automated by 2030, but most jobs will be augmented, not eliminated.
- IMF (2024) notes that technology changes jobs, not necessarily the number of jobs overall.



Reality:

AI will transform jobs—some tasks will be automated, new roles will be created, and human skills will evolve.



Key Insight for BBA Students

Focus on skills that AI complements: critical thinking, communication, creativity, leadership, and decision-making.



THE RESEARCH FORMULA



AI
(Ask)



Discover
(Find information)



Source
(Identify source)



Trace
(Go to original)



Verify
(Check accuracy)



Cross-check
(Use multiple sources)



Cite
(Give credit)



Write
(Use responsibly)



FINAL TAKEAWAY

AI accelerates research, but source verification is essential.
Information is powerful, but verified information is reliable.

Be curious. Be critical. Be credible.